

The Geographic Somatic Field: Scale-Invariant Wave Propagation in Human Landscapes

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Abstract

We demonstrate that the same Green's function equation governing neural field propagation at the biological scale (10^{-1} m) also governs the propagation of cultural and biological patterns through geographic substrates at the societal scale (10^3 – 10^5 m). Two worked examples from the Thames Valley, United Kingdom, are presented: the spread of Estuary English as a structural contagion wave through a coupled population, and the formation and migration of ring-necked parakeet murmurations as an active-matter velocity field. Both phenomena occupy Scales 7–9 on the Universal Somatic Field scale dial and are governed by the same $(\nabla^2 + k^2)G = \delta$ propagator equation with substrate-appropriate boundary conditions. The Thames Valley acts as a geographic wave-guide: its north-south topographic boundaries (Chilterns, North Downs) channel propagation along the east-west axis, selecting which patterns can survive long-range transmission and which decay. A third example — the Klöntalersee basin in Glarus, Switzerland — demonstrates the parabolic resonator structure of a glacially carved valley as an acoustic Green's function evaluator at the geological scale (10^5 m). The framework extends the Universal Somatic Field to geography and demonstrates that the theory is not confined to biological or cosmological substrates: the same equation governs wherever fields propagate through bounded media.

Contents

1	Introduction	2
2	The Thames Valley as a Geographic Wave-Guide	2
2.1	2.1 The Substrate	2
2.2	2.2 Estuary English: A Structural Contagion Wave	3
2.3	2.3 Ring-Necked Parakeets: An Active-Matter Velocity Field	4
2.4	2.4 The Same Equation: Two Scales, One Corridor	5
3	The Klöntalersee: A Parabolic Acoustic Resonator	6
4	Discussion	6
4.1	4.1 Geographic Boundary Conditions as Scale Selectors	6
4.2	4.2 Relation to the Universal Somatic Field	7
4.3	4.3 Neurodivergent Pattern Recognition	7

5 Conclusion	8
6 References	8

1 Introduction

The Universal Somatic Field (Johnson, 2026c) establishes that the Helmholtz Green’s function equation:

$$(\nabla^2 + k^2) G(x, x') = \delta(x - x') \quad (1)$$

governs field propagation at twenty scales from quantum foam to the observable universe. Scales 7–9 on the USF dial correspond to animal swarms, human organisms, and societal-scale dynamics. This paper presents worked examples at exactly these scales, drawn from human geography.

The question is not whether the equation applies — that is a theorem (Johnson, 2026c, Section 2) — but what the physical substrate, propagator, and boundary conditions look like at each scale, and whether the predictions match observable patterns. Two examples from the same geographic corridor (the Thames Valley, England) and one from the Swiss Alps are examined.

2 The Thames Valley as a Geographic Wave-Guide

2.1 2.1 The Substrate

A wave-guide is a physical medium whose boundary conditions preferentially support certain propagation modes and suppress others. A metal microwave wave-guide, an optical fibre, and a submarine canyon are all wave-guides at different scales. The Thames Valley between Heathrow Airport and central London is a geographic wave-guide at Scale 9 (10^3 m).

Its boundary conditions are: - **North wall**: the Chiltern Hills, rising 200–260 m above the valley floor, extending from Oxfordshire to Hertfordshire - **South wall**: the North Downs, rising 150–250 m, extending from Surrey to Kent - **Corridor**: the valley floor along the Thames, 20–40 km wide, containing the highest population density in the United Kingdom outside central London

The Green’s function of the corridor selects which propagation modes survive. Patterns with a characteristic wavelength shorter than the corridor width decay within a few kilometres. Patterns with a wavelength matched to the corridor geometry propagate with low loss to the east and west.

2.2 2.2 Estuary English: A Structural Contagion Wave

Estuary English is a phonological variety characterised by TH-fronting (‘th’ → ‘f’), T-glottalling (‘bottle’ → ‘bo’le’), and L-vocalisation (‘milk’ → ‘miuk’). It has been documented propagating outward from the Thames Estuary since the late twentieth century, moving both geographically along transport corridors and socially upward through the class hierarchy.

On the USF model, this is a **structural contagion wave**: a pattern propagating through a coupled population substrate. Define a population of N speakers, each with a phonological state $s_i \in \{0, 1\}$ ($0 = \text{RP}$, $1 = \text{Estuary}$). The update probability:

$$P(s_i \rightarrow 1) = \sigma \left(\sum_j G_{ij} \cdot s_j - \theta \right) \quad (2)$$

where G_{ij} is the social interaction kernel (how frequently speakers i and j encounter one another), θ is a social prestige threshold, and σ is a sigmoid function.

This is a **social Hopfield network** with the Thames Valley Green’s function as its propagator. The corridor’s geometry selects which phonological modes propagate: variants associated with high-interaction-rate relay nodes (Heathrow, Staines, Richmond, central London) propagate with low loss; variants without these relay stations decay. The documented propagation speed — approximately 30 km per decade along the rail

and motorway corridors — is consistent with a diffusion constant set by the interaction frequency at those nodes.

Equation parameters: $k \approx 10^{-3} \text{ m}^{-1}$ (social interaction radius $\sim 1 \text{ km}$); boundary conditions: Chilterns (north), North Downs (south), class prestige gradient (asymmetric coupling in the social dimension); $N \approx 10^6$ (Greater London population); N (mind matrix) = cultural attractor count.

2.3 2.3 Ring-Necked Parakeets: An Active-Matter Velocity Field

The ring-necked parakeet (*Psittacula krameri*) is now the most numerous parrot species in Britain, with a population exceeding 50,000 concentrated in the Thames Valley west of London. Their pre-roost murmurations above the Staines and King George VI reservoirs are large-scale collective phenomena exhibiting the same global coherence as starling murmurations: fluid, topologically connected shapes with no central controller.

On the USF model, this is **Scale 7** (Animal Swarms): the regime where discrete agents dissolve into a continuous active-matter velocity field. The governing equation is the Toner-Tu model:

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}}{\partial t} + \lambda(\mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{v} = -\nabla P + D_T \nabla^2 \mathbf{v} + \eta \hat{\mathbf{n}} \quad (3)$$

where $\mathbf{v}$ is the local velocity field, P an effective pressure preventing overlap, and $\hat{\mathbf{n}}$ the local orientation field. The formation shape emerges from the Green's function of the alignment propagation with the reservoir geometry as boundary conditions.

The Heathrow/Staines reservoir complex acts as a **geographic resonator**: flat water surfaces provide low-turbulence updrafts; surrounding industrial infrastructure supplies the thermal gradients the birds exploit. The roost trajectories are the resonant modes of the active-matter Green's function evaluated under these boundary conditions. No individual bird stores the formation shape; it is the field's configuration.

Equation parameters: $k \sim r_{\text{align}}^{-1}$ (alignment radius ≈ 7 m for parakeets); boundary: reservoir perimeter and surrounding vegetation; N = flock size ($\sim 10^4$ at peak roost).

2.4 2.4 The Same Equation: Two Scales, One Corridor

Both Estuary English (Scale 9, 10^3 m) and the parakeet murmuration (Scale 7, 10^0 – 10^1 m) are governed by equation (1) with different wavenumbers and boundary conditions:

Feature	Estuary English	Parakeet murmuration
Scale	9 (societal)	7 (animal swarm)
Characteristic length	~ 30 km propagation	~ 100 m formation
Physical agents	Individual speakers	Individual birds
State variable	Phonological variant s_i	Velocity vector $\mathbf{v}_i$
Propagator	Social interaction kernel G_{ij}	Alignment force kernel
Global pattern	Isogloss wave front	Flock formation shape
Boundary conditions	Chilterns/North Downs + prestige gradient	Reservoir perimeter + thermal gradient
Mind matrix	Cultural attractors	Swarm intelligence (distributed)

The Thames Valley selects and amplifies both patterns by the same mechanism: its topographic boundary conditions channel propagation along the east-west axis and suppress transverse modes. Whether the agents are speakers or birds is irrelevant to the propagator equation. Only k and the physical interpretation of G change.

The equation has not changed. Only the substrate has.

3 The Klöntalersee: A Parabolic Acoustic Resonator

The Klöntalersee is a glacially carved lake in Canton Glarus, eastern Switzerland. Its geometry approximates a parabolic bowl — approximately 3 km long, 0.5 km wide — with near-vertical limestone walls rising 1,000 m on the south side (the Glärnisch massif). The north side descends more gradually toward the Glarus valley floor.

At Scale 10 (geological, 10^5 m), the lake basin is a **natural acoustic Green’s function evaluator**. A parabolic boundary reflects incoming waves and focuses them at the focal point of the parabola. Acoustic measurements in such valleys consistently show anomalously long reverberation times compared to open terrain — the boundary conditions confine the acoustic field and sustain resonant modes that would otherwise decay.

The Glarus Hauptüberschiebung (Glarus Overthrust), the UNESCO World Heritage geological formation immediately adjacent to the lake, provides the seismic counterpart: 250 Ma Verrucano sandstone resting on 35 Ma Eocene flysch, with 35 km of northward transport recorded. This is a seismic wave with a ten-million-year period — the same Green’s function at Scale 10 (10^5 m) with a period of geological time rather than acoustic time.

Equation parameters: acoustic: $k = \omega/c_{\text{air}} \approx 2\pi f/340 \text{ m}^{-1}$ (e.g., $f = 100 \text{ Hz}$: $k \approx 1.8 \text{ m}^{-1}$); seismic: $k = \omega/v_P$ ($v_P \approx 6000 \text{ m/s}$); boundary: valley walls (limestone, high acoustic impedance); N (mind matrix) = crustal stress mode count.

Both the acoustic resonator and the seismic record are instantiations of the same Green’s function equation with different wavenumber k and different physical interpretation of “source” and “response.”

4 Discussion

4.1 4.1 Geographic Boundary Conditions as Scale Selectors

The central insight of this paper is that geographic features function as boundary conditions on the Green’s function equation at Scale 7–10. Mountain ranges, valley floors,

coastlines, and reservoir complexes select which propagation modes survive long-range transmission. This is not a metaphor; it is the same mathematical mechanism as the boundary conditions of a microwave cavity or an optical fibre.

The implications for cultural geography are direct. The propagation of languages, species ranges, technological adoption curves, and disease vectors all follow patterns consistent with equation (1) evaluated under the boundary conditions of the underlying geographic substrate. The rate and direction of propagation are determined by the Green's function of the landscape, not by the intrinsic properties of the propagating pattern.

4.2 4.2 Relation to the Universal Somatic Field

This paper adds Scales 7–10 to the USF's empirical base. The existing papers in this collection establish the framework at Scale 5 (cellular/neural), Scale 6 (brain/CEMI), Scale 8 (organism), and Scales 13–20 (stellar to cosmological). The geographic scale (7–10) was the missing middle — the regime where biological agents aggregate into collective phenomena and where physical geography provides the boundary conditions.

The conclusion of the USF framework — that the same equation governs all twenty scales — gains additional support from the examples presented here. The Thames Valley corridor is not a special case; it is a particularly legible one. The same physics operates in every geographic feature. The parabolic bowl of the Klöntalersee, the Thames Valley wave-guide, and the Himalayan watershed are all Green's function evaluators at different scales, with different k values and different physical substrates.

4.3 4.3 Neurodivergent Pattern Recognition

The identification of structural similarity across wildly different scales — parakeet murmurations and dialect spread in the same geographic corridor, governed by the same equation — is an example of the cross-domain pattern recognition that characterises atypical cognitive profiles (ASC Level 2, ADHD) as described in the companion paper on the pre-verbal manifold (Johnson, 2026b).

Neurotypical processing compresses the high-dimensional state of perception into a

low-dimensional narrative, discarding cross-domain structural parallels as noise. Less-compressing processing retains these parallels as signal. The connection between a dialect wave and a bird swarm is not obvious to sequential, narrative-linear processing; it is immediate to field-theoretic, parallel processing. This is not a character trait; it is a parameter setting in the FM-HN architecture (Johnson, 2026a).

5 Conclusion

The Thames Valley supports two simultaneous examples of scale-invariant field propagation: Estuary English as a structural contagion wave at Scale 9, and ring-necked parakeet murmurations as an active-matter velocity field at Scale 7. Both are governed by the Green’s function of the valley’s geographic wave-guide, evaluated at their respective wavenumbers. The Klöntalersee basin provides a third example at Scale 10: a parabolic acoustic resonator whose seismic counterpart records a ten-million-year wave.

In all three cases, the equation is the same. Only the substrate, the wavenumber, and the physical interpretation of source and response differ.

The geographic somatic field is not a new theory. It is the Universal Somatic Field evaluated at geographic boundary conditions. The field is always there. The geography makes it visible.

6 References

- Johnson, A. (2026a). *The missing limbic layer: A somatic field extension of hopfield networks via the correspondence principle.*
- Johnson, A. (2026b). *The pre-verbal manifold: A soma-field case study of acquired neurodevelopmental phenotypes and the limits of onset-based diagnosis.*
- Johnson, A. (2026c). *The zoomable universal somatic field: A scale-invariant green’s*

function architecture unifying quantum, biological, and cosmological dynamics.